MODULE 3 · KNOW YOUR SCHEMES

DigiLocker: Keeping Your Documents in Place

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Lost marksheets, a misplaced Aadhaar photocopy, a driving licence you forgot at home, all solvable with one free government app. DigiLocker is basically a government-backed folder for your most important documents, and unlike a folder on your phone, the documents in it actually hold up legally.

1. What Is DigiLocker?

DigiLocker is a Government of India platform, run by the Ministry of Electronics and IT, that stores digital versions of your official documents, fetched directly from the government departments that issued them.

- It's free, and open to any Indian citizen with a mobile number.
- Documents pulled directly from an issuer (like your Aadhaar from UIDAI, or your marksheet from your board) are called "Issued Documents," and they carry the same legal validity as the physical original.
- You can also upload scanned copies of other documents for safekeeping, but these are just convenience copies, they don't carry that same automatic legal weight.

2. Setting It Up

1. Download the DigiLocker app, or go to https://www.digilocker.gov.in/
2. Sign up with your mobile number, and verify with the OTP sent to it.
3. Set a security PIN or password for your account.
4. Link your Aadhaar number to unlock automatic fetching of documents issued in your name. If you don't have Aadhaar yet, there's a separate option to continue without it.

That's the whole setup. From here, most documents fetch themselves, you rarely need to upload anything manually.

3. What You Can Actually Pull Into It

Once it's set up, DigiLocker can fetch a surprising range of documents directly from the source, already digitally signed and verified.

- Identity: Aadhaar, PAN card, Voter ID.
- Education: CBSE and many state board marksheets and certificates, often needed directly for exam forms like JEE Main or NEET.
- Vehicles: Driving Licence, Registration Certificate (RC), insurance, and PUC certificate, all pulled from the Parivahan database.
- Others, depending on your state and issuer: ration card, caste or income certificates, and more are being added over time.
- Not everything fetches instantly, some state issuers are slower to sync than central ones. If something won't pull automatically, check back later or contact the issuing office.

4. Is It Actually Legal? Yes, Genuinely

- Under Section 9A of the Information Technology Act, 2000, documents in your "Issued Documents" section are legally equivalent to the physical original.
- This has been specifically confirmed for driving licences and RCs by the Ministry of Road Transport, meaning traffic police are required to accept them, not just "allowed to."
- Colleges, banks, and government offices increasingly accept DigiLocker documents directly, verified through the QR code on each document.
- The catch: this legal status applies to "Issued" documents fetched from the source, not to a photo or scan you've personally uploaded. Know the difference before you rely on one in an important moment.

5. Handy Uses for Students Specifically

- Entrance exam forms (JEE Main, NEET, and others) let you pull your Aadhaar and marksheets directly from DigiLocker instead of manually uploading scans, fewer format errors, faster application.
- If you're stopped for a traffic check once you're driving, your DL, RC, insurance, and PUC pulled from DigiLocker or mParivahan are accepted exactly like the physical cards.
- Applying for a scholarship, an internship, or a bank account often needs the same 3-4 documents repeatedly, having them ready in DigiLocker saves you from digging through files each time.

A Few Myths, Busted

Myth	Fact
A photo of my licence in my phone gallery is basically the same as DigiLocker.	Only documents fetched into DigiLocker's "Issued" section carry legal validity. A gallery photo doesn't, no matter how clear it is.
Traffic police can refuse to accept a DigiLocker driving licence.	The Ministry of Road Transport has specifically ruled that DigiLocker DL and RC must be accepted at par with physical originals.
DigiLocker is only useful once you're an adult with a licence or PAN card.	Even in school, DigiLocker helps with marksheets and Aadhaar for exam forms like JEE and NEET, useful well before 18.

Useful Links

DigiLocker · *sign up, link Aadhaar, and start pulling your official documents*

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